

CHANGE CONTROL APPROACH

Project: StudentSarathi – Student Income and Part-Time Job Platform

Framework: PRINCE2

1. Purpose

The purpose of the Change Control Approach is to define how changes to the approved project baselines (scope, schedule, cost, and quality) will be identified, assessed, approved, and controlled throughout the lifecycle of the StudentSarathi project.

This approach ensures:

- Controlled delivery of the MVP platform
- Prevention of uncontrolled scope expansion
- Alignment with business objectives and student market needs
- Protection of project timeline and budget
- Transparent and auditable decision-making

2. Scope of Change Control

This approach applies to all changes that may impact:

- MVP functionality and feature set
- Project schedule and milestones
- Budget and resource allocation
- Technical architecture and integrations
- User experience and platform quality

All stakeholders including Project Manager, development team, students, employers, and Project Board are required to follow this process.

3. Project Context

StudentSarathi is an MVP-based digital platform designed to connect students with part-time job opportunities.

Core MVP Features

- Student registration and profile management
- Employer job posting system
- Job search and application functionality

Any enhancement beyond these features is considered a formal change request.

4. Change Classification

4.1 Minor Change

Low-impact changes with no effect on scope, cost, or timeline.

Examples:

- Text corrections
- UI adjustments
- Minor content updates

Approval Authority: Project Manager

4.2 Significant Change

Moderate-impact changes affecting functionality but not overall project direction.

Examples:

- Adding job filters
- Enhancing search functionality
- Notification features

Approval Authority:

- Project Manager
- Stakeholder consultation (if required)

4.3 Major Change

High-impact changes affecting scope, timeline, cost, or business case.

Examples:

- AI-based job recommendation system
- Payment gateway integration
- Expansion into freelancer marketplace

Approval Authority:

- Project Board
- Business Case reassessment required

5. Change Control Procedure

The following structured process will be followed:

Step 1: Change Request Submission

All changes must be submitted via a Change Request Form (CRF) by any stakeholder.

Step 2: Change Logging

The Project Manager records the request in the Change Log Register, including:

- Change ID
- Description
- Requestor
- Date submitted

Step 3: Initial Screening

The Project Manager evaluates:

- Alignment with project objectives
- Relevance to MVP vs future phases

Step 4: Impact Assessment

Each change is assessed against:

- Scope impact
- Schedule impact
- Cost implications
- Risk exposure
- Quality impact

Step 5: Decision Making

Possible outcomes:

- Approved
- Rejected
- Deferred to future phase

Approval is based on the Change Authority Matrix.

Step 6: Implementation

For approved changes:

- Development activities are planned and executed
- Testing and validation are conducted
- Deployment is controlled

Step 7: Documentation Update

The following documents are updated as required:

- PID
- Project Plan
- Risk Register
- Change Log

Step 8: Closure

The change is formally closed once:

- Implementation is completed
- Outcomes are verified
- Documentation is updated

6. Change Authority Matrix

Change Type	Approval Authority
Minor	Project Manager
Significant	Project Manager with Stakeholder Input
Major	Project Board

7. Tools and Documentation

The following tools support change control:

- Change Request Form (CRF)
- Change Log Register
- Impact Assessment Template
- Updated PID and Project Plan

8. Key Principle

No change shall be implemented without formal approval.

This ensures:

- Stability of MVP delivery
- Controlled feature evolution
- Predictable project performance

9. Example Scenario

Change Request: AI-based job recommendation system

Impact Analysis:

- Scope: Expands beyond MVP
- Time: Additional 3–4 weeks
- Cost: High
- Risk: Increased technical complexity

Decision: Deferred to Phase 2

10. Summary

The Change Control Approach ensures that StudentSarathi is delivered in a controlled and structured manner. It enables informed decision-making, protects project constraints, and supports scalable growth beyond the MVP phase.